

The senses

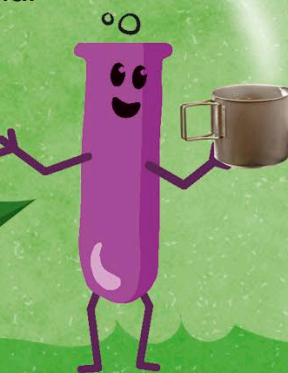
Our senses let us understand the world around us. They tell us what's safe and what's dangerous, and let us see and hear each other. Special receptors in our bodies help us to sense our world.

Sight

A lens inside each of our eyes focuses light onto the back of the eye. There, receptors sense brightness and colours.

The main senses

Sight, smell, touch, taste, and hearing are our five main senses. However, we also have other senses that help us survive.



Smell

Tiny receptors inside the nose pick up many different odours. Smell is closely linked to the sense of taste.

Touch

The skin contains many receptors that react when we touch things.



Taste

Taste buds on the top of the tongue sense five different flavours. These are salty, sweet, sour, bitter, and a savoury flavour called umami.